Nazanin Khazra

nazanin.khazra@utoronto.ca · https://nazaninkhazra.com

Current Position

University of Toronto 2020–present
Assistant Professor, Teaching Stream, Department of Economics

Additional Affiliations

School of Cities, University of Toronto 2022–present

Notable University Service

Academic Board, Governing Council, U of T (elected member) 2025–2030

Education

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
Ph.D. in Economics 2020
Sharif University of Technology
M.Sc. in Economics 2012
University of Tehran
B.Sc. in Economics 2009

Research Interests

Applied microeconomics, real estate, household finance, causal machine learning, and artificial intelligence

Working Papers and Research in Progress

Heterogeneities in House Price Elasticity of Consumption

Does Airbnb Reduce Matching Frictions in the Housing Market? with Abdollah Farhoodi and Peter Christensen

The Economic Impact of Menstrual Hygiene Products on Household Expenditures: An Analysis of Costs and Financial Burden

Menstrual Health Policy Implementation: A Review of Tax, Access, and Infrastructure Across Contexts, co-authored with students

Articles and Working Papers in Pedagogy

Generative AI in Action: Using AI to Scaffold Economic Writing Skill Development, with Victoria Sheldon. Working Paper 809, Department of Economics, University of Toronto, December 2025.

Khazra, N. (2023). **Facilitating Scaffolding and Team Projects in Non-Computer Science Courses with GitHub Classroom.** In deNoyelles, A., Bauer, S., & Wyatt, S. (Eds.), Teaching Online Pedagogical Repository. Orlando, FL: University of Central Florida Center for Distributed Learning.

Beyond Apprenticeship: A Co-Authored Research Community Model for Undergraduate Economics Education

Resting Papers

Investment Decisions Based on Profit Status: Evidence from Hospitals

Emergence of Tech-Econ: Teaching Machine Learning and Big-Data Skills to Economics Students

Open-Source Books and Teaching Resources

Learning Microeconomics with Python (MicPy) with Mathew Laad (draft available by request)

Research Mentoring TA Manual: an open-source manual for training teaching assistants as research mentors in research-based economics courses (fourteen chapters, rubrics, templates, and a feedback quiz).
`https://github.com/NazaninKhazra/research-mentoring-ta-manual`

Econ Data TA: an AI teaching assistant for project-based data courses, released as a system prompt for other instructors.
`https://nazaninkhazra.com/econ-data-ta.html`

Data for Economists: an open catalogue of 75 datasets with suggested research questions for project-based economics courses.
`https://nazaninkhazra.com/data-catalogue.html`

Grants

SSHRC Insight Development Grant, pass-through of taxes on menstrual products 2026–2028

Research Experience

Khazra Research Lab (K.R.L.) for Applied Economics and Data Science,
Principal Investigator 2025–present
Undergraduate, MA, and PhD research assistants; monthly research seminars

Big-Data in Environmental Economics and Policy Group 2018–2020
Collaboration with National Center for Supercomputing Applications

Moody's Analytics Summer 2018
Quantitative Research Intern

National Bureau of Economic Research Summer 2017
Research Assistant for Prof. Jialan Wang (UIUC)

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign 2015
Research Assistant for Prof. JiHyung Lee

Teaching

Applied Causal Machine Learning (ECO1465, MA/PhD), U of T 2024–present
Select topics: *Double Machine Learning, Generalized Random Forest, DeepIV*

Big Data Tools and Applied ML for Economists (ECO250Y0) Aug. 2023
University of Oxford, U of T Summer Abroad
Select topics: *ChatGPT API, Cross Validation, Bagging, Boosting, Random Forest*

Data Tools for Economists (ECO225), U of T 2020–present
Select topics: *GIS mapping, HTML and API web scraping, working with GitHub, text analysis*

Microeconomic Theory and Applications (ECO204, Commerce), U of T
2025–present
Select topics: *constrained optimization in Python, Game Theory in Python*

Microeconomic Theory (ECO200), U of T 2020–2025

Applied Machine Learning in Economics (ECON 490), UIUC 2019–2020
Select topics: *LASSO and Ridge, Bagging, Boosting, Random Forest, Support Vector Machines, Neural Networks*

- Robert E. Demarest Memorial Teaching Award
- Ranked in the top 5% of all teachers in the university

Honors and Awards

Outstanding Teaching Award, Early Career, Faculty of Arts & Science, U of T	2024
Merit Award (Excellence/Small Group), Economics, U of T	2022–2026
Robert E. Demarest Memorial Teaching Award, UIUC	2019
Outstanding, List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent, UIUC	2015–2019
Summer Research Fellowship, UIUC	2015
Department Fellowship, UIUC	2014
Ranked 5th in the National Exam for Economics Graduate Schools	2009

Certificates

Certificate in Effective College Instruction, ACUE and ACE	Mar. 2022
Graduate Teacher Certificate, CITL, UIUC	May 2019

Workshops

ML Bootcamp for Faculty, U of T Data Science Institute	June 2022, 2026
Machine Learning Summer Program, University of Chicago	Aug 2021
CSWEP Mentoring Workshop, American Economic Association	Jan 2022

Select Conference Presentations

TeachECONference, University College London	2026
CNEE panel, Canadian Economics Association	2026
Mount Royal University SoTL Symposium	Oct. 2025
Canadian Economics Association	May 2025
TeachECONference, University College London	June 2024
Pedagogy seminar, University of British Columbia	May 2024
Real Estate Seminar, City University of New York	May 2023
TeachECONference, University College London	June 2022
American Economic Association (ASSA)	Jan 2022
American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association, ASSA	Jan 2022
American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association, National	June 2021
AEA Conference on Teaching and Research in Economic Education	June 2021
TeachECONference, University College London	June 2021
Urban Economics Association (UEA)	October 2020
Applied Economics, Regional, and Urban Studies Conference (AERUS)	April 2019

Conference Organizer

Tech-Econference, U of T undergraduate research symposium (6 editions)	2021–2026
Masters in Economics Student Research Symposium (MERS), with C. Ward	2026

Relevant Volunteer Experience

Volunteer Researcher, Canadian Economics Diversity Committee (CEDC)	2023–present
Liaison for U of T, CSWEP (American Economic Association)	2022–present
Organizer, U of T Economics team, CIBC Run for the Cure (five editions)	2022–present
Mock job-market interviews for women PhD students, U of T Economics	2023–present